

3.3.5 Polymers

Students should have knowledge and understanding of the following content.

Content	Additional guidance and suggested TDAs	Specification reference GCSE Combined Science: Trilogy	Specification reference GCSE Combined Science: Synergy
Outcome 10			
Polymers such as poly(ethene), poly(propene) polystyrene and PVC are made from small compounds called monomers that join together to form very long chains. Polymers are waterproof, resistant to chemicals, and can be moulded, so they have many useful applications as packaging materials, pipes and containers.	Common names of these polymers will be accepted. Knowledge of the names of other polymers is not required.	5.2.2.5	4.6.2.4
Many polymers are not biodegradable, so they are not broken down by microbes. This can lead to problems with waste disposal.	Suggested activity for TDA Compare the biodegradability of different polymers and other materials.		